

UNIT 13

Statistical Techniques

Unit Overview

13.1 Introduction
13.2 Role of statistics in geography
13.3 Types of Data
13.4 Methods of collection of Data
13.5 Organisation and Classification of Data
13.6 Statistical techniques measures of central tendency

Learning Objectives

- *To Understand the concepts of geographical data*
- *To know the various types and methods of data collection.*
- *To analyse and interpret various data used in geography*
- *To develop and understand the measures of central tendency*

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13.1 Introduction

Statistics is a branch of science which deals with quantitative data. Actually statistics includes in four processes.

1. Collection of Data
2. Presentation of Data
3. Analysis of Data
4. Interpretation of Data

13.2 Role of statistics in geography

Statistical techniques and procedures are applied in all fields of academic research; wherever data are collected and summarized or wherever any numerical information is analyzed or research is conducted, statistics are needed for sound analysis and interpretation of results.

Geographers use statistics in numerous ways

- To describe and summarize spatial data.
- To make generalizations concerning complex spatial patterns.
- To estimate the probability of outcomes for an event at a given location.
- To use samples of geographic data to infer characteristics for a larger set of geographic data (population).
- To determine if the magnitude or frequency of some phenomenon differs from one location to another.
- To learn whether an actual spatial pattern matches some expected pattern.

For example, a student studying the annual rainfall in a particular region will first of all

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